

Often reluctantly, I suggest going in for a branded PC. Now I know branded PCs are generally more expensive than their assembled counter parts. They don't offer the same bang for the buck, but for those who've never assembled a PC and don't want to, this is an easy way to get a computer home. Walk into a shop, select a model, pay and you have your PC delivered to your doorstep the following day.

Of course, the selecting part isn't simple. You still need to know what goes into your PC. The processor, memory and graphics solution are what will give you the performance. You also don't want to be stuck with a 17-inch CRT monitor or a system with no speakers at all. Shopping for PCs is a little tricky and Lamington might not be the best place to do this. Most of the computer stores do not house retail shops and showrooms of the manufacturers. This means you might have to research a little bit before you actually go out to buy a PC.

There are different kinds of PCs, and obviously, you can't just go buy a PC for gaming for example. Manufacturers split up their PC line-ups for different kinds of users. Typically, desktops for office use are designed to take up little space. They aren't extremely powerful either, but they should come bundled with ergonomic keyboards and decent screens.

I went to the Acer showroom looking for PCs for a small office one of my friends was helping set up. I found a few models under the Aspire Value line-up – the cheaper IE3520 and the IE4740. The IE3520 runs on the slower Core 2 Duo E5200 while the IE4740 uses the E7400, which is a little faster. These processors with the 2 GB of memory are more than sufficient for office applications as well as internet browsers and email clients. These days, don't look for any PC that comes with a CRT monitor. LCD monitors are more compact, generate less heat and save some money in the long run. And not to mention the fact that they are crisper and better performing in most areas as compared to CRTs.

Alienware Aurora ALX

